

Kismet Operating System – Integrated Synthesis & Recommendations (Google-First, Optional Airtable)

Executive Summary

The **Kismet OS** concept unifies Customer Relationship Management (CRM) and Project Management into a single low-code system. Previous planning documents explored both a **Google-centric architecture** using AppSheet, Google Sheets, Apps Script and Looker Studio, and an alternative **Airtable + Microsoft 365** stack. Recent discussions clarified that Microsoft 365 is off the table, but that Airtable may still play a role as an optional scalability layer. This report synthesizes those materials and the latest guidance from Shane, recommending a **Google-native implementation** that can evolve into a hybrid with Airtable when needed. It also identifies missing capabilities and provides a phased build plan.

Key Insights

Topic	Evidence & Rationale
Data normalization is critical	AppSheet's own guidance stresses that repeating information across rows will cause errors and recommends breaking data into separate tables linked by references ¹ . Each table should have a unique identifier to support one-to-many relationships ² . This aligns with the original Kismet design, which separated <i>Companies</i> , <i>Contacts</i> , <i>Deals</i> , <i>Interactions</i> , <i>Tasks</i> , etc. into discrete entities.
Spreadsheets are prototypes, not production databases	An article on spreadsheet development notes that spreadsheets are ideal for sketching ideas but often become unmaintainable when used as production systems; migrating stabilized spreadsheets to a more robust technology is recommended ³ . Moving Kismet from Google Sheets to a more robust database (Airtable or BigQuery) later fits this principle.
Airtable is powerful but has limits	Airtable's Enterprise tier allows up to 500 000 records per base ⁴ , but this can be restrictive for high-growth businesses with large datasets. The record limit, plus licensing costs and automation quotas, means Airtable should be treated as a workflow/front-end layer , not the definitive system of record.
Enterprise features are required for regulated industries	A review of Airtable notes that features like SAML-based single sign-on , controlled vendor visibility , data-loss prevention (DLP) with audit logs and key management are only available on Enterprise plans ⁵ . For financial or regulated sectors, these are mandatory.

Topic	Evidence & Rationale
Airtable vs. AppSheet	The Airtable/Microsoft pivot reduces code debt by replacing custom Apps Script with native automations, but it introduces higher costs and the 500 k record limit. AppSheet is cheaper and integrates tightly with Google Workspace but relies on scripts for complex logic and lacks Enterprise-grade governance. The recommendation is therefore to build Kismet on Google first , then introduce Airtable behind the scenes if record volumes or workflow complexity outgrow Google Sheets.

Recommended System Architecture (Google-First with Optional Airtable)

Core Components (Phase 1–2)

1. **Data layer (Google Sheets / AppSheet Database)** – Define normalized tables such as **Leads, Contacts, Appointments, Deals/Opportunities, Tasks, Interactions, Workshops**. Each table gets a unique ID column to maintain relational integrity ². Avoid storing lists or repeated data in a single row; instead create new tables and connect them via **Ref** columns ¹.
2. **Application & workflow layer (AppSheet)** – Create an AppSheet app that exposes forms, views and Kanban boards for each pipeline stage. Use role-based interfaces to separate rep activities (lead capture, follow-ups, consult bookings) from management views (dashboards, KPI reports).
3. **Automation layer (Apps Script / AppSheet Automation)** – Implement automations such as:
 4. **Lead assignment** – Round-robin or rule-based assignment; create tasks for reps.
 5. **Consult booking** – Connect AppSheet to Google Calendar to schedule consults and send confirmation emails.
 6. **Missed call handling** – Log missed calls via a call-logging service (e.g. Twilio) and generate tasks; send a templated apology email instead of SMS.
 7. **No-show and “Not Ready Yet” workflows** – Automatically create follow-up tasks when consults are missed or prospects defer; send periodic check-in emails.
 8. **Analytics & dashboards (Looker Studio)** – Build dashboards showing lead volume by source, consult conversion rates, strategy sales, deal closure rates, and revenue per stage. Use the relational structure to calculate pipeline conversion metrics.
 9. **Communication & identity (Gmail & Google Calendar)** – Use Gmail for all automated email interactions (confirmation, follow-up). Avoid SMS by default, consistent with Shane’s direction.

Optional Scalability Layer (Phase 3+)

If Kismet grows to tens of thousands of deals or multi-team operations, Google Sheets may become a bottleneck. At this stage:

- **Introduce Airtable as an operational interface** – Use Airtable for active records to leverage native automations and interface designer. Keep the authoritative data in a more scalable warehouse (e.g. BigQuery) or in partitioned sheets; sync a subset of active records to Airtable. Treat Airtable as a front-end and workflow layer rather than a permanent database of record.
- **Enterprise governance** – If regulatory requirements apply (e.g. financial services), move to Airtable's Enterprise plan to access **SAML SSO, DLP with audit logs, key management and data-retention policies** ⁵. Without these controls, storing sensitive information in Airtable could breach compliance.
- **Hybrid Integrations** – Use Make.com (or another integrator) to handle complex logic, error-handling and cross-platform automations when AppSheet's built-in automations are insufficient.

Phased Implementation Plan

1. Foundation & Pipeline 1 (Lead → Consult)

2. Set up normalized tables (Leads, Contacts, Appointments, Tasks, Interactions).
3. Build *Pipeline 1* board in AppSheet to manage new leads: status values like **New → Contacted → Consult Booked → Not Ready → Disqualified**.
4. Capture leads from multiple sources (door knock form, web form, Meta leads) via forms/webhooks; automatically assign to reps and create tasks.
5. Document: Provide a one-page cheat-sheet and Loom video for reps.

6. Consult & Strategy Flow (Pipeline 2)

7. Add **Appointments** and **Deals** tables; build *Pipeline 2* board: **Booked → Completed → Strategy Offered → Strategy Accepted / Lost**.
8. Integrate consult booking with Google Calendar; send pre-meeting reminders via Gmail.
9. Implement “no-show” handling and “Not Ready Yet” nurture tasks; ensure these transitions are captured in the data to enable accurate conversion reporting.

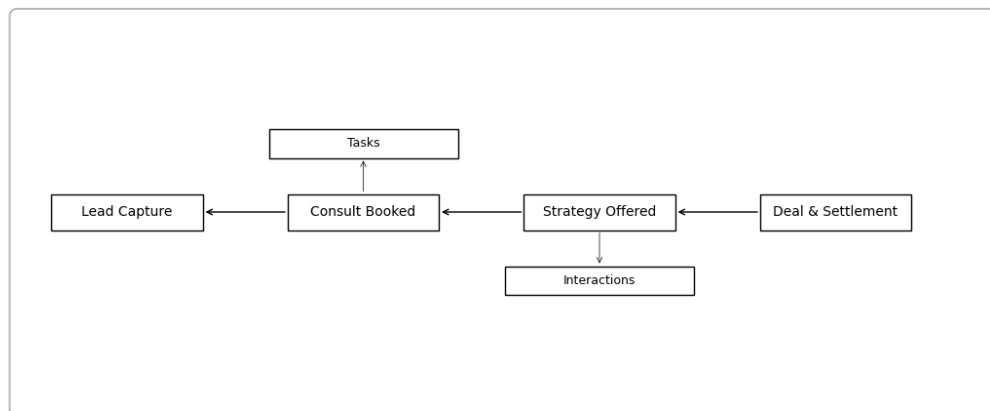
10. Deal & Settlement Flow (Pipeline 3) and Dashboards

11. Extend the schema to include **Deals/Opportunities** with fields for fee ranges, property details, commissions and settlement dates.

12. Build *Pipeline 3* board: **Identified Proposal** → **In Progress** → **Contracts** → **Settled/Completed**.
13. Create Looker Studio dashboards for management: lead counts, consult conversion rate, strategy uptake, deal settlement value, revenue per rep.
14. Document: Produce system map, user guides and short training videos.
15. **Scalability & Governance (Optional)**
 16. Assess record counts and workflow complexity. If active data exceeds ~20 000 rows or automations become brittle, pilot Airtable as an interface layer. Keep the primary data store in Google BigQuery or partitioned Sheets.
 17. Upgrade to Airtable Enterprise if storing regulated data so you can leverage **audit logs, DLP and SAML SSO** ⁵ .
 18. Continue using Gmail/Calendar for communications; Twilio for call status only (no automated SMS) to maintain rep-proof workflows.

Visual Representation

The diagram below illustrates the simplified **pipeline flow** recommended for Kismet OS. Leads enter the system, progress through **Consult Booked**, **Strategy Offered**, and finally **Deal & Settlement** stages. **Tasks** and **Interactions** are supporting entities attached to the main flow.



Missing Areas & Additional Recommendations

1. **AI-assisted note taking and summarisation** – The original documents mention NotebookLM and RAG capabilities. Google’s NotebookLM can be integrated to summarise interactions and generate meeting notes, but this should be piloted carefully to ensure data privacy and avoid hallucinations.
2. **Marketing Integration** – While the pipeline focuses on lead handling, integrating digital marketing data (Meta ads, Google Ads) into the data model would allow calculation of cost-per-acquisition and ROI. Use connectors or Make.com to ingest campaign metrics.

3. **Data warehouse for historical data** – For long-term analytics and to bypass Airtable’s record limit ⁴, plan a warehouse such as BigQuery. Periodically archive settled deals and interactions from Sheets/Airtable into the warehouse; connect Looker Studio for longitudinal reporting.
4. **Security & Compliance** – If Kismet handles financial or sensitive data, ensure that whichever platform (Google or Airtable) supports DLP, audit logs and SAML SSO ⁵. Without these controls, you could face regulatory risk. Consider SOC 2 compliance if selling services to other businesses.
5. **Governance & Documentation** – Document data schemas, automations and user responsibilities. This helps prevent knowledge loss and ensures the system can be maintained when team members change.

Conclusion

The proposed **Kismet OS** should start with a **Google-native architecture** using AppSheet, Sheets/Database, Apps Script, Gmail and Looker Studio. This maximizes affordability and leverages Kismet’s existing familiarity with Google tools. Data must be normalized into separate tables with unique keys ¹ to avoid the “spreadsheet fallacy” ³. Automations should focus on simple, rep-proof workflows using email and tasks rather than SMS. When record counts or workflow complexity outgrow Google Sheets, **Airtable** can be introduced as a workflow layer, provided it is deployed at the **Enterprise** tier to access necessary governance features ⁵ and with a plan for storing large datasets externally ⁴.

¹ ² Data: The Essentials - AppSheet Help

<https://support.google.com/appsheet/answer/10106580>

³ The Better Spreadsheet Fallacy | Smurf on Spreadsheets

<https://smurfonspreadsheets.wordpress.com/2010/02/10/the-better-spreadsheet-fallacy/>

⁴ Airtable Record Limits - a quick explainer | Whalesync

<https://www.whalesync.com/blog/airtable-record-limit>

⁵ Airtable Review: Is It Worth It in 2025? [In-Depth]

<https://www.smartsuite.com/blog/airtable-review>